Letter of Intent – Africa Peacebuilding Institute 2026 Annual Online Training

Dear Admissions Committee,

I am applying for the Africa Peacebuilding Institute 2026 Annual Online Training to strengthen my skills in conflict analysis, mediation, and program design for peacebuilding in my region as I am serving.

For ten months, I have supported community dialogue forums and mediation processes involving youth, local leaders in areas affected by resource disputes in the refugee settlements. While these efforts have reduced tensions in the short term, I recognize that sustainable peace requires deeper technical skills and frameworks rooted in African contexts. I have reached a point where practical experience alone is not enough. I need structured training to improve how I analyze conflict dynamics, design interventions, and facilitate processes that prevent escalation.

The Africa Peacebuilding Institute is well known for delivering rigorous, context-specific training that blends theory with practical tools. I am particularly interested in the modules on conflict-sensitive design, negotiation and mediation, and monitoring and evaluation. These align directly with my current work on strengthening community early-warning systems and building local capacity for non-violent dispute resolution. The online format will allow me to remain active in ongoing projects while immediately applying new methods in the field.

If selected, I will commit fully to the program and focus on translating learning into practice. I plan to integrate the frameworks into two current initiatives: a youth-led mediation network and monitoring and evaluation in the refugee settlement.

I believe lasting peace in Africa will be led by Africans equipped with the right skills and networks. I am eager to learn from the Institute's faculty and peers, and to return with tools that strengthen both my work and the wider peacebuilding ecosystem in my region.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,
Emmanuel Effiong Akpan